

3 Autocracy and revolt in Russia, 1881-1914



- The reign of Alexander III
- Problems facing Nicholas II, 1894-1905
- The 1905 Revolution
- The Dumas and Stolypin
- The growth of opposition to Tsarist rule

- Impact of assassination of Alexander II. Alexander III, Pobedonostsev and reaction. Restoration of autocracy, censorship and the policy of Russification.
- Weaknesses of Nicholas II as Tsar. Witte and industrial growth. Problems facing Nicholas II including the discontent of the peasants, town workers and subject nationalities (ethnic minorities).
- The Russo-Japanese War (1904-5) and Father Gapon and Bloody Sunday (January 1905). Key events of the 1905 Revolution. The *Potemkin* Mutiny and the setting up of Soviets. The October Manifesto and reasons why Nicholas survived.
- The attitude of Nicholas to the first four *dumas*. Stolypin's policy of repression and land reform. The Lena Goldfield strike.
- Emergence of opposition groups including the Constitutional Democrats (Cadets), Octobrists, Social Revolutionary Party and Social Democrats. Split in Social Democrats – Mensheviks and Bolsheviks.